GLOBAL INTELLIGENCE

Daily Intelligence Report

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At a Glance

- **Democrats win Congress:** CBS and CNN project Democrats took the House and Senate in Tuesday's US midterms (final counts are not verified). Trump reportedly accepted the result. From January Congress can block legislation and open investigations, but his tariffs and military decisions stay in his hands.
- **Eurozone inflation 4.0%:** Eurostat's flash estimate for October is up from 3.8%, the fastest pace in three years. Core inflation is 2.5%. Energy is the driver, because the Strait of Hormuz is still closed in the ninth month of the Iran war. The FT reads this as keeping the ECB on course for another rate rise.
- **European stocks rally, banks lead:** The European bank index rose 4.4%. Milan's FTSE MIB gained about 2.3% to near 51,000, with UniCredit and Intesa up about 5%. The BTP-Bund spread narrowed to 112 basis points and the 10-year BTP yields 4.43%. Defence stocks fell.
- **Asian tech whipsaw:** The Nikkei fell as much as 4.8% on fears of tougher US scrutiny of AI, with some chip shares down over 13%. Asian stocks then recovered most of the losses. Tesla and SpaceX fell in pre-market trading.
- **Oil and gas stay high:** Brent is about $102, down roughly 12% on the week, after Trump reportedly ruled out imminent strikes on Iran. Indirect US-Iran talks via Qatar continue. Dutch TTF gas is near €88-92/MWh, and EU storage is 74.6% full, the lowest entering winter since 2013.
- **Trump says US aid to Israel will end:** He said the roughly $3.8bn a year would stop. The timing is unclear and analysts doubt it will happen.
- **Ukraine diplomacy:** US, UK, EU and NATO officials meet in Brussels ahead of Abu Dhabi talks, reportedly around 10-11 November. These would be the first US contacts with Russia and Ukraine since February, and Moscow has not confirmed attendance. Russian strikes killed at least 38 people in 24 hours.
- **Washington squeezes China tech:** Oracle cancelled a $7bn AI-compute deal with Tencent under US pressure. Chinese buyers expect only about 1% of the $70bn of Nvidia RTX chips they ordered.
- **Italy's budget room:** Rome's request to use the EU escape clause for defence and energy goes to finance ministers around 9 November. Meloni met Confindustria on the 2027 budget, and Electrolux job cuts were nearly halved to just over 900.
- **Freezer cyberattacks:** Supermarkets in 10 countries, Italy included, reported tampered refrigeration systems, and many threw away food. Attribution is unconfirmed.

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What It Means for You in Italy

- **Gas and electricity bills:** Arera says the gas price for vulnerable households rose 9.1% in October to €88.36/MWh. With TTF back near €88-92, relief is not imminent. Italy's storage is 91% full, so supply risk this winter is lower than in Germany (61%).
- **Mortgages and loans:** Eurozone inflation at 4.0% keeps another ECB hike on the table. The next meeting is 16-17 December. Variable-rate mortgages tied to Euribor could get dearer, but a December move is analyst opinion, not an ECB commitment.
- **Prices:** Brent at about $102 keeps fuel and transport costs high. It is down on the week, so a pump-price easing is possible but not certain.
- **Savings and BTPs:** The 10-year BTP yields 4.43%. After 4.0% inflation, the real return is only about 0.4% a year before tax.
- **Jobs:** The Electrolux deal cuts redundancies from over 1,700 to just over 900. Cerreto d'Esi stays open until it is reindustrialised, with exit incentives up to €95,000.
- **Taxes and budget:** Rome plans to use about 0.3% of GDP each for defence and energy in 2027 and 2028. The final use is undecided, and the Council of Ministers cannot take up the budget until the energy guidelines are set.
- **Food and cyber:** Some supermarket stock was lost to the freezer attacks. Italy's cybersecurity agency (ACN) called retailers to a meeting, and no price effect is reported.

Markets Dashboard

Europe	Last	Day	Week
Euro Stoxx 50	6,247.92	+1.68%	+1.30%
FTSE MIB (Italy)	51,020.05	+2.16%	+2.40%
DAX (Germany)	26,242.98	+1.46%	+2.10%
CAC 40 (France)	8,149.06	+1.61%	+3.32%
IBEX 35 (Spain)	19,350.90	+2.89%	+2.48%
FTSE 100 (UK)	10,789.53	+1.42%	+0.89%

Americas	Last	Day	Week
S&P 500	7,568.92	+0.36%	-1.99%
Nasdaq 100	28,180.26	+0.68%	-4.96%
VIX (US volatility)	18.41	-11.62%	+8.87%
Bovespa (Brazil)	165,529.00	-1.43%	-6.27%

Asia	Last	Day	Week
Nikkei 225 (Japan)	62,188.63	-1.42%	-1.71%
CSI 300 (China)	4,101.33	–	–
Hang Seng (Hong Kong)	23,919.50	+1.67%	+3.57%
KOSPI (South Korea)	5,683.80	+0.62%	-5.47%
Taiex (Taiwan)	42,948.91	-0.83%	-8.69%
Nifty 50 (India)	23,960.60	+0.63%	+5.56%

Rates	Last	Day	Week
US 10Y yield (%)	4.9520	+1.19%	-0.82%
US 2Y yield (%)	4.7750	+0.00%	+0.53%

Currencies	Last	Day	Week
EUR/USD	1.1265	+0.65%	+1.22%
EUR/GBP	0.8348	+0.03%	-0.16%
EUR/CHF	0.9183	+0.24%	-0.44%
EUR/CNY	7.4900	+0.66%	+0.95%
US Dollar Index (DXY)	101.30	-0.56%	-0.87%
USD/JPY	158.30	+0.25%	+0.20%
USD/CNH	6.6707	–	–
USD/RUB	81.89	+0.79%	+1.67%
USD/INR	94.64	-0.09%	-0.57%
USD/BRL	5.4702	+0.62%	+2.24%
USD/TRY	50.02	+0.06%	+0.44%
Bitcoin ($)	78,150.72	+1.04%	+1.23%

Commodities	Last	Day	Week
Brent ($/bbl)	101.44	-2.08%	-12.04%
WTI ($/bbl)	94.52	-1.63%	-8.04%
Dutch TTF gas (EUR/MWh)	87.79	-4.16%	-12.84%
Gold ($/oz)	4,054.30	+2.89%	+0.07%
Silver ($/oz)	52.12	+5.11%	-2.50%
Copper ($/lb)	6.4470	+1.07%	-2.93%
Wheat (c/bu)	600.00	+0.04%	+0.17%

Delayed exchange quotes, last daily close (Yahoo Finance). Prices, not policy facts.

I Europe & Italy

Italy

Rome's attention is on the 2027 budget, an industrial deal at Electrolux and sharply lower bond yields.

Meloni meets Confindustria on the budget as markets rally

Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni received Confindustria president Emanuele Orsini at Palazzo Chigi this morning. Orsini said they discussed "industry, the budget law and energy" and called it a "frank and constructive dialogue". The 2027 budget is still waiting on guidelines for how to spend the energy and defence flexibility (see the next section).

Market impact: The BTP-Bund spread, the yield gap between Italian and German 10-year bonds, fell to 112 basis points. It closed at 113.2 yesterday after opening at 115.5. The 10-year BTP yields 4.43%, down 3 basis points. Milan's FTSE MIB rose about 2.3% and is close to 51,000 points. Banks led (Intesa, UniCredit, Fineco, Bper), while defence names fell (Leonardo, Avio, Fincantieri). The rally followed the US elections and Deutsche Bank's reading that they put a "brake on extreme policies".

Watch: The Council of Ministers cannot take up the budget until the energy guidelines are set.

Sources: ANSA, Il Sole 24 Ore, ANSA, ANSA

Electrolux deal at the industry ministry nearly halves job cuts

At the Mimit, the Ministry of Enterprises and Made in Italy, unions Fiom, Fim and Uilm signed an agreement with Electrolux. Redundancies fall from over 1,700 to just over 900. Investment rises to €100m and output is set at 3.2 million units. The Cerreto d'Esi plant stays open until it is reindustrialised. Exit incentives reach up to €95,000. The government has promised to refinance the wage-support schemes and "expansion contracts" (early-retirement tools).

Why it matters: Home appliances are a core Italian manufacturing sector, and this is one of the few recent restructurings where job cuts were cut back.

Sources: Il Sole 24 Ore

Mattarella calls for a common EU defence

In remarks to the armed forces, President Sergio Mattarella urged "immediately" building a common EU defence and strengthening NATO. He added that "Italy rejects war and respects international law".

For Europe & Italy: The call lands as defence stocks fall and the government weighs how to use its defence flexibility.

Sources: ANSA

Gas: storage is high but bills are rising

Italian gas storage is 91% full, against 74.5% for the EU and 61% for Germany. Amsterdam TTF gas, the European benchmark, is back above €92/MWh. The regulator Arera says gas bills for "vulnerable" households in October rose 9%. It blames wholesale prices, with the Strait of Hormuz still closed.

Sources: ANSA, ANSA

European Union

Eurozone inflation hits 4%, the fastest pace in three years

Eurostat's flash estimate puts October inflation at 4%, up from 3.8% in September. The FT says headline pressure is accelerating and core inflation (which excludes food and energy) remains well above the ECB's 2% target. In its reading, that keeps the central bank on course for another rate rise.

Why it matters: The shock comes from energy, with Hormuz closed in the ninth month of the war. The ECB is now tightening into a supply shock, which is costly for indebted governments such as Italy's.

Market impact: European bond yields fell today despite the data. Gold rose 2.6% overnight and the dollar and oil softened after the US vote.

Watch: I could not confirm the date of the ECB's next policy meeting.

Sources: ANSA, FT

Lagarde warns on climate as the succession race tightens

ECB President Christine Lagarde called this year's hot summer a "warning". She said regions hit by heat saw economic activity fall by 1.5%, and she cited Spain as a model on energy policy. She said renewables work as a buffer against shocks. Bloomberg notes that almost a third of ECB Executive Board members have left before finishing their eight-year terms. Governments must nominate candidates for her successor by Friday 6 November, and finance ministers discuss them on 9 November.

Sources: ANSA, Bloomberg

Defence integration: Berlin denies putting its own industry first

German Defence Minister Boris Pistorius rejected claims that Germany puts its arms industry ahead of Europe's. He said protecting national weapons makers is a problem common to all EU countries.

Why it matters: Joint procurement is the core of EU defence plans, and national preferences are the main obstacle.

Sources: Politico Europe

Ukraine diplomacy runs through Brussels

The FT reports that US, UK, EU and NATO officials meet in Brussels this week ahead of talks in Abu Dhabi. These would be the first US contacts with Russia and Ukraine since February. Moscow's attendance is not guaranteed.

Sources: FT

Italy in the EU & PNRR

The Commission has already given a favourable opinion on Italy's request to use the EU's "national escape clause". This lets a country spend more on defence and energy without counting it against its deficit limits. Finance ministers are due to confirm it at the Ecofin meeting on 9 November. Reports differ on the exact date, so check the Council's calendar.

Escape clause: Council vote on 9 November

Rome applied on 11 September, and the Commission gave a positive opinion on 8 October. Italy's parliament authorised the use of the clause on 13 October. The government indicates about 0.3% of GDP each for defence and energy in 2027 and in 2028, within an overall ceiling of 1.5% of GDP. Reports put the sums at roughly €14bn, but they do not agree. Economy Minister Giancarlo Giorgetti had not yet decided how to use the room as of 2 November. One report puts the Commission's opinion on Italy's budget plan at 24 November, which I could not confirm.

Watch: The 9 November Ecofin, then the Commission's opinion on Italy's draft budget.

Sources: ItaliaOggi, ANSA, La Mia Finanza

PNRR tracker

Italy sent the request for the tenth and last instalment, worth €28.4bn, on 29 September. Minister Tommaso Foti says all 576 targets of the plan are met. No payment or Commission verdict has been reported yet.

Item	Status	Next step
10th instalment (€28.4bn)	Requested on 29 Sept; Commission assessment under way	Commission verdict, then payment
9th instalment (€12.8bn)	Received in June 2026	None
Plan revision	Approved 3 June; €2.1bn redirected to Industria 5.0 and housing	Final spending

Sources: Teleborsa, Agenzia Nova, Milano Finanza

Across Europe

Germany

BMW's nine-month revenue fell to €92.7bn and profit dropped 24.4%, mostly because of China. Handelsblatt says a still weaker fourth quarter looms, and the company is running a cost-cutting programme. Germany's gas storage is only 61% full, far below Italy's 91%. A Handelsblatt commentary calls Berlin an increasingly "helpless" top backer of Ukraine, since Kyiv's fate is decided in Moscow and Washington. In September, Chancellor Friedrich Merz rejected talk of stepping down early after a heavy defeat in Saxony-Anhalt.

Sources: ANSA, Handelsblatt, Handelsblatt

France

Prime Minister Sébastien Lecornu's 2027 budget includes €54bn of savings and aims for a deficit of 5% of GDP. He has no majority in the Assemblée. The hard-left LFI party has promised to vote to topple the government over the bill. Parliament has 70 days to examine it, until about 26 November. These details come from earlier coverage, not today's news. The armed forces minister said France is investing in naval power.

Sources: LCP, Breaking Defense

United Kingdom

Andy Burnham leads Labour and the government, after Keir Starmer resigned in June. The UK meat industry was hit by a cyberattack that targeted supermarket freezers across Europe. Stores in Ireland, Sweden and Belgium reported fridge temperatures being raised on Monday.

Sources: PBS, BBC

Nordics, Baltics and Portugal

The BBC says supermarkets in 10 countries, from Estonia and Sweden to Portugal and Italy, reported freezer problems, and many threw away food. In the Baltic Sea, Sweden and Finland worry about escalating tensions with Russia while trying to counter its behaviour.

Sources: BBC, Defense News

Spain

Lagarde named Spain's energy policy as an example of how renewables can cushion shocks.

Sources: ANSA

II Great Powers

United States

Democrats appear to have won control of both the House and the Senate in Tuesday's midterms. That is the projection from CBS and CNN, and I could not verify the final seat counts. Jon Ossoff held his Georgia Senate seat. In Texas, James Talarico beat the Republican Ken Paxton. Elon Musk had put $47mn into Paxton's campaign, according to the FT. A Democrat, Jon Rosenthal, also won a seat on the Texas oil regulator, the Railroad Commission, for the first time since 1990 (Bloomberg). Italian press reports that Trump accepted the result and said he would work with the opposition. Markets welcomed that.

Why it matters: From January, Democrats can block Trump's legislation and open investigations. Bloomberg Economics says voters blamed tariffs and the Iran war for their cost-of-living problems. Tariffs imposed by executive order and military action stay in Trump's hands. A Democratic Congress can still use budgets, oversight and war-powers votes to pressure him.

For Europe & Italy: The FT says European capitals want to stay the course and avoid retaliation from a "wounded" Trump. The Ukraine talks and Iran policy will be the first tests of how far Congress constrains him.

Market impact: The reaction was calm after an early dip. Milan closed the morning up about 2.3%, with banks leading: UniCredit and Intesa each rose about 5%. Madrid gained 2.9%, and Frankfurt and Paris about 1.5%. The dollar weakened, with the euro near 1.125. Gold rose as much as 3.5% to about $4,040 an ounce. Brent fell about 1.3% to around $102 after Trump reportedly ruled out imminent strikes on Iran. The BTP-Bund spread narrowed to 112 basis points, with the 10-year BTP at 4.43%. Japan's Nikkei fell as much as 4.8% on worries about tougher scrutiny of AI. Asian stocks later recovered most of those losses, as traders judged the fears overdone.

Watch: Final House and Senate counts, any Trump moves on tariffs before January, and the Apec summit in Shenzhen in about two weeks.

Sources: Bloomberg, ANSA, FT, Bloomberg Economics, CNN

China

The FT reports that the US, Russia and China are discussing a Trump-Putin-Xi meeting. Trump is due in Shenzhen for the Apec summit in about two weeks. No date or venue for a three-way meeting has been confirmed.

Why it matters: A leaders' meeting would be the main diplomatic event of the autumn. The talks would cover trade and technology curbs, and also Ukraine and Iran. Beijing gains standing by hosting both leaders.

Washington pressures US firms over China tech

The FT reports that Oracle cancelled a $7bn AI deal with Tencent under pressure from the Trump administration. Bloomberg reports that Chinese AI developers expect to receive only about 1% of the roughly $70bn of Nvidia RTX chips they ordered, because Nvidia cannot raise production fast enough. Tencent released a new open-weight AI model on Wednesday and says it joins China's top tier.

Market impact: Chinese AI and chip firms face tighter supply. Semight Instruments, a maker of chip test equipment, has hired CITIC, Goldman Sachs and JPMorgan for a Hong Kong listing.

Robotics funding cools

Fundraising by Chinese robotics firms fell to about 11 billion yuan ($1.6bn) in October, according to Bloomberg. Investors worry about a shakeout after the frenzy that followed Unitree's humanoid showcase at the Spring Festival.

Carmakers and the Pacific

BMW cut its targets for the second time since June, blaming weak sales in China. It is also widening its job cuts, per Handelsblatt and the FT. In Papua New Guinea, China disputes reports that a 32kg object found there was an artillery shell. Police had earlier called it a "dummy".

For Europe & Italy: Weak Chinese demand hurts German carmakers and their Italian suppliers. China is also pushing the EU toward a broader debate on cutting its dependence on China.

Watch: The date and agenda of Trump's Shenzhen trip, Chinese trade data for October, and further PBOC steps on the yuan.

Sources: FT, FT, Bloomberg, Bloomberg, Bloomberg, Handelsblatt, BBC

Russia & Ukraine

The FT reports that US, UK, EU and Nato officials will meet in Brussels this week ahead of talks in Abu Dhabi. These would be the first US talks with Russia and Ukraine since February. Earlier reporting put the Abu Dhabi round at around 10-11 November. Moscow's attendance is not guaranteed.

Why it matters: The earlier rounds this year, in Abu Dhabi and Geneva, produced no deal. Europeans are trying to coordinate positions before Washington sits down with Moscow. Handelsblatt argues Germany is Kyiv's biggest backer but that Ukraine's fate is being decided in Moscow and Washington.

Russian strikes kill dozens

The BBC reports that at least 38 people were killed in 24 hours after Russian attacks on an aid centre, a hospice and a hospital. Zelensky warned that dozens more could be trapped under rubble. This follows the strike on the aid point in Komyshuvakha, Zaporizhzhia, that killed at least 29 people. I could not independently check Russia's account of these attacks.

Weapons for Ukraine

The US Air Force has asked industry how to mass-produce the Extended Range Attack Munition (ERAM), a low-cost cruise missile, for Ukraine. The request covers more than 1,000 missiles with a range above 250 nautical miles. Responses are due on 19 November. Deliveries would start within three months of a contract award and finish within 15 months (Defense News).

> **Background — ERAM:** The Trump administration announced a sale of 3,350 ERAMs to Ukraine in August 2025, worth $825 million. This new request is about finding manufacturers able to build them.

Nordic worries and cyber

Sweden and Finland are weighing how to counter Russian behaviour in the Baltic without escalating, Defense News reports. Russia's Interior Ministry says it dismantled the VasyGrek cybercrime group's infrastructure and detained three suspects.

For Europe & Italy: European air defence and ammunition stocks are stretched. Italy is part of the Brussels coordination effort.

Watch: Whether Russia confirms its delegation for Abu Dhabi, and the Brussels outcome.

Sources: FT, BBC, Defense News, Defense News, Handelsblatt, The Record

III World Regions

Middle East & Gulf

The war with Iran is in its ninth month, with diplomacy running through Qatari mediators and no deal yet. The day's new fact is a US announcement about aid to Israel.

Trump says US military aid to Israel will end

On 3 November, on Fox News, Trump said the US is "stopping" its roughly $3.8bn a year in military aid to Israel, which he put at "$4 billion". CNN reads this as an end-of-year cut. AFP said the timing was unclear, and Ynet reported it would start in 2027. Trump said Netanyahu was "fine" with it.

Why it matters: The aid is a 10-year memorandum of understanding (MOU) running from 2018 to 2028. It is about $3.3bn for US-made equipment and $500m for missile defence. Analysts quoted by CNN doubt it will be carried out, especially if US operations against Iran resume. MS NOW reports Netanyahu had wanted a gradual taper over 10 years, and that Israeli officials were surprised by the timing.

Watch: Any formal US notice or congressional response, and the Israeli reaction.

Sources: France 24, CNN, FT

Iran: indirect talks continue, oil holds near $104

Qatar's foreign ministry says both sides are weighing new mediator proposals. Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi confirmed indirect contacts, but Iran's national security chief called Washington's reply unsatisfactory. Brent was steady above $104 on Wednesday, down more than 8% this week (Trading Economics).

Market impact: Oil and gas are trading on each Iran headline. Bloomberg Economics says voters in the US midterms blamed tariffs and the Iran war for high living costs, which adds pressure on Trump to settle.

For Europe & Italy: Expensive gas and oil feed Italian bills and the ECB's inflation debate.

Sources: Trading Economics, Bloomberg

Qatar to be the largest buyer of US LNG; Turkey's $20bn scandal

The FT reports that Qatar, long the top LNG producer, will hold the largest share of US LNG output by 2033. Separately, the FT says a scandal involving about $20bn has cost investors billions in Turkey. Critics blame cronyism in Erdoğan's administration. I could not read the full article, so details are limited.

Sources: FT, FT

Indo-Pacific

The region's main story is the market reaction to the US midterms, which hit tech and AI stocks. Security news came from North Korea and from India's military build-up.

Tokyo tech slump after the Democratic sweep

The Nikkei 225 fell as much as 4.8% on Wednesday. Chip and AI-related shares were the worst performers, with some down more than 13% (Japan Times). Bloomberg later reported that Asian stocks recovered almost all early losses, as traders judged fears of tougher US scrutiny of AI overdone.

Market impact: This follows last week's chip sell-off led by Seoul. Watch Nvidia-linked names in Tokyo and Seoul.

Sources: Japan Times, Bloomberg

North Korea fires "several" missiles

Pyongyang tested several missiles on 4 November. Tokyo issued no alert, which it normally does for launches that could threaten Japan. The type and range were not given in the feed. North Korea denies responsibility for the $6.3bn Binance theft, which Binance's CEO ties to a months-long campaign using fake recruitment interviews.

Sources: Japan Times, The Record

India builds up its navy and army

India ordered next-generation corvettes worth $5.7bn from domestic yards. It is also buying carrier-capable fighters from France and submarines from Germany. It also changed its short-term recruitment scheme, extending tenures and offering a path to permanent jobs, as tensions with China and Pakistan continue.

Sources: Defense News, Bloomberg

Other moves

- **GCAP:** Talk of Germany joining the Japan-UK-Italy fighter programme is growing. Tokyo fears a new partner could delay the 2035 service date. Italy is a partner.
- **Data centres:** Google will spend $15bn on Malaysian data centres. Deloitte says Australia's construction boom, boosted by data centres, will be double the mining peak and push up prices.
- **Cyber:** The airline data breach now covers over 200,000 bookings, including Singapore Airlines.

Sources: Japan Times, Bloomberg, Bloomberg, Bloomberg

BRICS+ & Global South

There was no bloc-level BRICS news today. Member countries are dealing with US pressure and shaky markets individually.

South Africa votes in local elections

South Africans voted on 4 November, with voters angry about poor services. A September Ipsos poll cited by Daily Maverick put the ANC at 31%, the DA at 25% and Zuma's MK party at 14%, with MK ahead in Durban (eThekwini). It is one pre-election poll, and no results are out yet. The vote comes days after Trump moved to remove South Africa and Rwanda from a US trade arrangement.

Watch: The ANC's share in the big cities, and whether coalitions stay unstable.

Sources: BBC, Daily Maverick, Business Day

Brazil's central bank in a bind

Bloomberg expects Brazil's central bank to pause its rate cuts at its first meeting since Lula's re-election. Inflation expectations are worsening and political pressure is mounting.

Sources: Bloomberg

Gulf and Asian capital keep flowing

Qatar is set to become the largest buyer of US LNG. Google and Pure Data Centres are investing in Malaysia and in Europe and the Gulf.

Sources: FT, Bloomberg

Africa

Washington's pressure on Rwanda is spreading from trade into sport, and South Africa's local elections are the main political event.

Rwanda's army basketball team is out of the Africa league

The NBA, which runs the Basketball Africa League with FIBA (the world basketball federation), removed Rwanda's army team after US sanctions on Rwanda's defence ministry. Washington imposed them over Rwanda's role in the conflict in eastern DR Congo. Rwanda denies backing the M23 rebels, though UN experts have documented Rwandan military support. It is also losing its place in the US trade arrangement.

Watch: Whether other US sanctions or bans on Rwandan institutions follow.

Sources: BBC, BBC

South Africa votes

See the BRICS+ section for the election details. The ANC is under pressure over services such as water and electricity.

US contractor gave Ethiopia secrets in the Tigray war

An Ethiopian-born US citizen admitted sharing dozens of classified documents with senior Ethiopian officials. The aim was to help kill Tigrayan fighters, according to the BBC.

Why it matters: It shows the foreign hand in the 2020-22 Tigray war.

Sources: BBC

Economies

- **Ghana:** Inflation hit an 11-month high in October. Bloomberg expects the central bank to extend its rate pause.
- **Kenya:** The World Bank says GDP could rise by more than a fifth within a decade, with a much lower debt-to-GDP ratio, if graft is tackled.

Sources: Bloomberg, Bloomberg

Latin America

Brazil dominates. Lula's surprise re-election has hit markets and now constrains the central bank. A bank failure in Paraguay adds to the picture.

Brazil: rates on hold, doubts about the budget

Lula beat Flávio Bolsonaro by about 52% to 48% in the 25 October runoff (Al Jazeera put the result on 26 October). The real and the Bovespa stock index then fell sharply. Bloomberg Economics expects the central bank to pause cuts at its next meeting. Investors are waiting for Lula's choice of finance minister as a signal on spending discipline.

Market impact: A currency shock raises import prices and weighs on bonds. Brazilian assets are the first test of how markets treat a left-wing win in the region.

Sources: Bloomberg, Al Jazeera

Paraguay seizes Ueno Bank

Authorities began winding down the fast-growing digital bank Ueno over solvency problems. The FT notes its ties to President Santiago Peña.

Sources: FT

Chile weighed a rate hike

Minutes show Chile's central bank considered raising rates by a quarter-point in October because of rising cost pressures.

Sources: Bloomberg

IV Security, Technology & Space

Defence & Security

Diplomacy and arms supply on Ukraine dominate. European governments are also arguing over who builds the weapons.

US, UK, EU and NATO officials meet in Brussels ahead of the first US-Russia-Ukraine talks since February

The FT reports that officials from the US, UK, EU and NATO meet in Brussels this week to prepare discussions in Abu Dhabi with Russia and Ukraine. These would be the first such talks since February. Yesterday's edition put the Abu Dhabi round at 10-11 November. Russia's attendance is not confirmed.

Why it matters: The Brussels meeting is where Europeans try to shape the Western position before the US sits down with Moscow. Earlier rounds in Abu Dhabi and Geneva produced no agreement to end the war, according to Kyiv Post.

Watch: Whether Moscow confirms attendance, and whether the Europeans get a seat or only a briefing.

Sources: FT

US Air Force seeks industry to mass-produce ERAM cruise missiles for Ukraine

The service has asked contractors to mass-produce the Extended Range Attack Munition (ERAM), a lower-cost cruise missile for Ukraine. This comes after the $2.1bn Patriot sale reported yesterday.

Why it matters: Ukraine needs deep-strike weapons and air defence now, while Patriot deliveries stretch into the 2030s.

Sources: Defense News

Pistorius denies Germany puts its own arms industry first

Germany's defence minister Boris Pistorius told Politico that protecting national manufacturers is a problem common to all EU countries.

Why it matters: Fragmented procurement is a main obstacle to European rearmament. The row follows reports in June that the Franco-German-Spanish FCAS fighter programme had collapsed over industrial workshare, as the Forecast International analysis described it.

For Europe & Italy: On the eve of Armed Forces Day, President Mattarella urged "immediately" building a common EU defence and strengthening NATO. He said Italy "rejects war". Italian industry (Leonardo, Fincantieri) competes for the same European orders.

Sources: Politico Europe, ANSA

Other moves

- **France:** The armed forces minister said France is investing in naval power and that its military ambition is "to be feared". Macron used similar words in March, when he announced a larger nuclear warhead stockpile. Breaking Defense

- **India:** New Delhi ordered next-generation corvettes worth $5.7bn from domestic yards. It is also buying carrier-capable fighters from France and submarines from Germany. It extended tenure for short-term recruits amid tensions with China and Pakistan. Defense News, Bloomberg
- **Papua New Guinea:** China disputes reports that a 32kg object found there was an artillery shell. Local police had earlier called it "merely a dummy". BBC
- **Baltic Sea:** Sweden and Finland worry about escalating with Russia while countering its behaviour. Defense News

Cyber & Information Warfare

Supermarket freezer attacks spread across ten countries

The BBC reports that retailers from Estonia and Sweden to Portugal and Italy saw refrigeration systems tampered with. Stores in Ireland, Sweden and Belgium reported fridge temperatures being raised on Monday, and many discarded food. The UK meat industry was also hit. Yesterday's edition covered the Italian cases, and Italy's cybersecurity agency (ACN) called retailers to a meeting.

Why it matters: The target is physical stock rather than data. Reports on a similar October attack in France said the affected controllers were Danfoss products, mostly old models that no longer received security updates. Attribution there is unconfirmed.

Watch: Whether ACN or other European agencies name a common vendor or attacker.

Sources: BBC, BBC

Binance details the $6.3bn theft; Pyongyang denies it

Binance says a months-long campaign began in June. Attackers used fake job interviews to get an engineer to run malicious code, and its security tools missed the malware. Reportedly, US agencies blamed North Korea's TraderTraitor group, and Kim Yo Jong called the accusation "absurd". Binance says it froze about $2.85bn.

Sources: The Record, FT

Other items

- **Airlines:** Singapore Airlines is the latest carrier hit by a breach at a software supplier. More than 200,000 bookings are now compromised across the industry. Bloomberg
- **Russia:** Police say they dismantled the VasyGrek cybercrime group's infrastructure with help from Kaspersky and detained three suspects. This is the Interior Ministry's own account. The Record

Fact Check

No new debunk by a major fact-checker on the big stories of the last 24 hours surfaced in my research. Two claims from earlier editions, the "Oreshnik/nuclear alert" story and the "Republicans have already won everywhere" screenshot, are already covered.

The claim: North Korea "had nothing to do" with the Binance theft

Kim Yo Jong, a senior North Korean official, called the accusation "absurd" and said Washington itself seizes stolen crypto. The statement was reported on Monday.

Verdict: Unproven (denial); attribution rests on official US statements, not on independent verification.

What is actually true: US agencies, reportedly including the FBI, have blamed the TraderTraitor group. Binance's post-mortem describes fake recruitment interviews and says it blocked 57 North Korean attempts in 2026. Binance's findings and the agencies' attribution are not independently audited.

Why it matters: Pyongyang has an interest in denying a theft that funds its state. The denial is a political statement, not evidence.

Sources: The Record, FT

Technology & AI

Midterm results and US-China chip politics are moving AI stocks and deals.

Midterm "blue wave" sparks an AI scrutiny scare, then a partial recovery

Japan's Nikkei 225 fell as much as 4.8% on Wednesday, with chip and AI-related shares down more than 13%, according to the Japan Times. Bloomberg says Asian stocks recovered almost all early losses as traders judged fears of tougher US scrutiny of AI overdone. Democrats swept Congress.

Why it matters: Investors fear Democratic oversight of AI and big tech. The market is trading a political guess, not a policy change.

Market impact: AI and semiconductor shares in Asia took the biggest hit, then retraced. The Nasdaq 100 was already down 4.4% on the week, as reported yesterday.

Watch: Opening of Wall Street today and the first Democratic statements on AI hearings.

Sources: Japan Times, Bloomberg

Oracle cancels $7bn Tencent AI deal under Trump pressure

The FT reports that Oracle cancelled the deal after pressure from the Trump administration. Earlier reports described Tencent leasing about 100,000 advanced AI chips from Oracle for roughly $7bn. I could not verify the details beyond the FT headline.

Why it matters: Washington is now policing cloud rentals of US chips to Chinese firms, not just chip exports. Renting compute offshore was a way around export controls.

Market impact: Oracle loses a large contract. Chinese cloud buyers lose a supply route.

Sources: FT

Chinese clients to receive about 1% of the $70bn of Nvidia RTX chips they ordered

Bloomberg says Nvidia is struggling to raise production. Tencent separately released a model it says joins the top tier of Chinese open-weight systems. Chinese robotics funding slowed to about 11 billion yuan ($1.6bn) in October.

Why it matters: Chinese AI developers face a supply bottleneck on top of US controls, and some investors fear a robotics shake-out.

Sources: Bloomberg, Bloomberg, Bloomberg

Data-centre spending continues

- Google plans to spend $15bn on data centres and cloud in Malaysia. Bloomberg

- Oaktree-backed Pure Data Centres raised $780m, expandable by $1.1bn, for Europe and the Middle East. Bloomberg
- Australian design firm Canva is cutting about 22% of its workforce, citing AI-driven restructuring. Bloomberg
- The Economist asks what happens when supply of AI catches up with demand, using China's AI stock struggles as a warning. The Economist

Space

Musk's SpaceX and Tesla fall as Democrats take Congress

ANSA and Bloomberg report SpaceX shares down 6.9% and Tesla down 5.4% in pre-market trading. Handelsblatt notes that Musk was the biggest donor to Republicans.

Why it matters: SpaceX is the main US launch provider and a major defence contractor, so investors price political risk from a Democratic Congress. A Congress hostile to Musk could scrutinise his contracts. This is market pricing, not a policy action.

Watch: Whether the move holds after Wall Street opens, and any Democratic oversight statements on SpaceX contracts.

Sources: ANSA, Bloomberg, Handelsblatt

Czech and Belgian firms team up on a dual-use satellite

Spacemanic (Czech Republic) and Simera Sense (Belgium) will offer a combined satellite mission that they say can compete with bigger, heavier satellites. "Dual-use" means serving civil and military customers.

For Europe & Italy: It reflects the European push for small, sovereign satellites.

Sources: SpaceNews

I found no verified launch results in the last 24 hours. Yesterday's items, the Cygnus cargo ship due at the ISS in November and EQT's $300m purchase of Speedcast's ground-station unit, still stand.

V Economy, Markets & Energy

Global Economy & Central Banks

Inflation is rising again just as the ECB's leadership changes. US election results are also reshaping rate and growth expectations.

Eurozone inflation hits 4%, the highest in three years

Eurostat's flash estimate puts October inflation at 4.0%, up from 3.8% in September. Core inflation, which excludes food and energy, held at 2.5%. Services rose to 3.3% from 3.2%, and unprocessed food rose 4.6%. The rise is driven mainly by energy prices tied to the closure of the Strait of Hormuz.

Why it matters: The FT says the data keep the ECB on course for another tightening. Market reports say the ECB held rates on 29 October, with the deposit rate reported at 2.50%, after hikes earlier this year. Some analysts expect a further hike in December. That is analyst opinion, not an ECB commitment.

For Europe & Italy: Italy's regulator Arera said gas bills for vulnerable households rose 9.1% in October. Tighter ECB policy raises borrowing costs for Italian mortgages and for public debt.

Watch: The ECB's next meeting in December. Before that, eurozone governments must nominate candidates for ECB president by Friday 6 November, and finance ministers discuss them on 9 November.

Sources: Il Sole 24 Ore, FT, ANSA

Lagarde's early exit and a climate warning

Bloomberg Economics notes that almost a third of ECB Executive Board members have not completed their eight-year terms. Separately, Lagarde said this year's hot summer should warn Europe to build defences against the financial fallout of warming and make its energy system more flexible.

Sources: Bloomberg, Handelsblatt

Fed on hold, Bank of England next

Market reports say the Fed held at 3.75%-4.00% on 28 October, with two officials (Cook and Hammack) preferring a hike. The next meeting is 8-9 December. US mortgage rates fell for a third week but stayed above 7%. The Bank of England decides on Thursday 5 November. Goldman Sachs and JPMorgan were reported to expect a 25 basis point hike, but views are split. I could not confirm current market pricing.

Sources: Bloomberg

Markets & Finance

European stocks rallied hard after Democrats won Congress, with banks leading. Investors are betting that a divided Washington will rein in Trump's policies.

Banks lead a European rally

At midday ANSA reported Milan up 2.3%, Madrid up 2.9%, and Frankfurt and Paris up about 1.5%. The last close shows the FTSE MIB at 51,020, up 2.16%. The European bank index gained 4.4%. UniCredit and Intesa rose about 5.2%, and BPER and MPS about 4.8%. Defence stocks fell, including Leonardo, Avio and Fincantieri. Deutsche Bank's George Saravelos said the result should curb "extreme policies". That is an analyst's view.

Market impact: The dollar index fell 0.56% to 101.30, and EUR/USD is around 1.13. Treasuries rallied, with the 10-year yield near 4.93%. The BTP yield fell to about 4.43% and the BTP-Bund spread narrowed to 112 basis points, from 115.5 at Tuesday's open. Gold rose about 2.9% to $4,054 and silver 5.1%. Bitcoin is near $78,150, little changed after an early dip. Brent is around $102, down from $104 at the open, after Trump reportedly ruled out imminent attacks on Iran.

Tech stress in Asia: Japan Times said the Nikkei fell as much as 4.8%, with chip and AI shares down more than 13%. The Nasdaq 100 is down about 5% on the week. Tesla fell 5.4% and SpaceX 6.9% in premarket trading, as Democrats won Texas.

Company news: BMW's nine-month profit fell 24.4% on revenue of €92.7bn, and the company expects a weaker fourth quarter, with China the drag. Pure Data Centres raised $780m of debt, expandable to $1.9bn. The FT reports that a $20bn scandal is hitting Turkish investors.

Sources: ANSA, ANSA, Japan Times, Bloomberg, Handelsblatt

Trade, Tariffs & Sanctions

The US midterm result may shift trade policy. Washington is also using trade access as leverage in Africa.

Voters blamed tariffs, and trade policy may shift

Bloomberg Economics says voters blamed tariffs and the Iran war for their affordability problems. I could not read the full piece, so it is not clear what concrete changes it expects. A Democratic Congress could scrutinise tariffs but has no power to cancel them on its own. Trump's tariffs are mostly executive actions, so any change depends on his choices and on the courts.

Why it matters: Trade policy has been a main source of uncertainty for exporters, including Italy's.

Watch: Trump travels to the Apec summit in Shenzhen in about two weeks, where US-China trade is likely on the agenda.

Sources: Bloomberg

US pulls Rwanda and South Africa from a trade arrangement

Trump is removing Rwanda and South Africa from a US trade deal, per the BBC. It comes about a week after the US Treasury sanctioned Rwanda's defence ministry over the conflict in DR Congo. The US has also sanctioned Rwanda's army, and the NBA said the Rwandan army's team was removed from the Africa league because of this.

Why it matters: This shows the US tying market access to security and diplomatic conduct.

Sources: BBC, BBC

China exposure hits carmakers

BMW says China is weighing on results and is running a cost-cutting programme. Last week's Nvidia guidance on China and Brussels' plans to cut dependence on China show the same trend: supply chains are being reorganised.

Sources: Handelsblatt

Energy & Critical Minerals

Energy markets are still driven by Hormuz and the US-Iran talks. Prices have eased from last week, but Europe enters winter with low gas stocks.

Oil and gas ease but stay very high

Brent was about $104 early on Wednesday and fell to about $102 by midday, after Trump reportedly ruled out imminent attacks on Iran. The last close shows Brent at $101.44, down 12% on the week, and WTI at $94.52. Dutch TTF gas was above €92/MWh on Tuesday evening and closed at €87.79 in the latest quote, down 4.2%.

For Europe & Italy: Arera says gas for vulnerable customers cost €88.36/MWh in October, up 9.1%, which consumer groups call a record. The IEA says EU storage is 74.56% full, the lowest entering a heating season since 2013. Italy is at 91% and Germany at 61%. The IEA warns stocks could fall below 10% by the end of March 2027. Ursula von der Leyen says the closure has cost Europe €127bn in extra fossil fuel imports.

OPEC+: Seven members held November output quotas at 31.01 million barrels a day on 4 October. I could not confirm the result of the 1 November meeting.

Watch: US-Iran talk headlines, and weekly EU storage drawdowns.

Sources: ANSA, ANSA, ANSA

Texas elects a Democrat oil regulator

Democrat Jon Rosenthal beat Republican Bo French for the Texas Railroad Commission, the first Democratic win in 36 years. The body oversees the $200bn Texas oil industry.

Sources: Bloomberg

Metals and climate

Copper is at $6.45/lb, up 1.07% on the day but down 2.9% on the week. Silver is up 5.1%. Federchimica says the chemicals sector has cut greenhouse gases 73% since 1990.

Sources: Il Sole 24 Ore

VI Outlook

Market Implications

Asset or sector	Likely pressure	Driver	Already priced in?
Italian/EU banks	Up	Higher rates, lower spread, "brake" on extreme US policy	Largely: sector +4.4% today
Defence (Leonardo, Avio, Fincantieri)	Down	Rotation, Ukraine talk, budget-use uncertainty	Partly
Energy stocks	Mixed	Brent $102 versus Iran talks	Partly
Autos	Down	BMW cuts targets on China	Partly
Luxury	Mixed	China demand versus calmer politics	Unclear
Utilities	Mixed	Falling yields help, gas costs hurt	Partly
BTP-Bund spread	Down (narrower)	Risk-on, lower yields	Mostly: 112 bp
Rates	Mixed	Inflation 4% versus yields falling	Partly
EUR/USD	Up	Weaker dollar, index −0.56%	Largely: about 1.13
Oil	Down/volatile	Iran headlines	Partly: −12% week
Gas (TTF)	Up/volatile	Low EU storage, Hormuz	No
Gold	Up	Lower yields, political uncertainty	Partly: about $4,050
Tech/AI	Mixed	Fear of scrutiny, chip supply	Partly
Emerging markets	Mixed	Weaker dollar versus Brazil, Turkey stress	Partly

The main theme is relief. Investors treat a divided Washington as a limit on extreme policy, and that lifted banks, cut yields and softened the dollar. The move was large in one day. Deutsche Bank's reading is an analyst's view, not a policy change.

The conflict between falling bond yields and 4% inflation is the weak point. A hot data surprise or a hawkish ECB or Bank of England (BoE) could reverse the rate rally. Energy is the swing factor: a US-Iran deal would pull oil and gas lower, while failed talks would push them up. Tech depends on whether Democratic oversight turns into real AI regulation.

Market Opportunities & Risks

Educational only. These are themes, not recommendations.

Italian banks and BTPs

Banks are rallying: the sector is up 4.4% in Europe today, and Intesa has raised its 2026 guidance. Higher rates support lending margins. The BTP yield is about 4.43%, with the spread at 112 basis points. The risks are a sharp reversal in rates or the spread, a shock from energy prices, and possible extra taxes on bank profits. After such a big one-day move, the trade looks fairly crowded. The horizon is medium term. BTPs are exposed to *duration risk*: prices fall if yields rise.

Gold and safe havens

Gold rose to about $4,054 on hopes of lower yields and political uncertainty. It pays no income, and it can fall if real yields rise or the dollar rebounds. Silver is more volatile. This is a short-term, headline-driven move.

AI infrastructure after the sell-off

Nasdaq 100 is down about 5% on the week, and Asian chip stocks fell sharply. Data-centre financing continues, such as Pure's $780m debt raise. The drivers are huge capital spending and the debt that funds it. The risks are heavy debt, tighter US regulation, and a slowdown in AI demand. Valuations are still high, so this is not "cheap". The horizon is long term, with sharp swings along the way.

Energy

Oil and gas are headline-driven. A US-Iran deal could push prices sharply lower, while failed talks could push them up. Energy-linked stocks, commodity ETFs and Italian bills all depend on this single political outcome.

Investing basics: real returns

A 4.43% BTP yield sounds high. But with eurozone inflation at 4.0%, the *real* return is only about 0.4% a year before taxes. Real return means the return after subtracting inflation. If inflation rises further, the real return falls, and fixed-rate bonds lose purchasing power. Compare yields with inflation, not in isolation.

Sources: ANSA, ANSA

Scenarios

US-Iran talks and Hormuz

- **Base case:** Indirect talks via Qatar drag on, with oil in a $95-110 range and gas elevated. This is the most likely path.
- **Upside:** A framework deal reopens Hormuz, Brent falls sharply and inflation pressure eases. This is possible but not likely soon.
- **Downside:** Talks collapse and US strikes resume, sending Brent and TTF higher. This is unlikely but costly.
- **Signposts:** Qatari statements, Iranian security chief remarks, weekly EU storage drawdowns, Trump's tone.

ECB tightening and the Lagarde succession

- **Base case:** The ECB holds in December and signals data dependence, while governments agree a successor by early 2027. This is likely.
- **Upside:** Energy prices ease, inflation peaks and no hike is needed.
- **Downside:** Core inflation rises and the ECB hikes into the supply shock, pushing up BTP yields and the spread. This is plausible.

- **Signposts:** The 6 November nomination deadline, the 9 November finance ministers' discussion, services inflation, December projections.

Ukraine talks in Abu Dhabi

- **Base case:** Talks happen with limited progress and no ceasefire, as in earlier rounds. This is likely.
- **Upside:** Moscow attends and agrees a partial deal, such as an energy or air truce. This is unlikely.
- **Downside:** Russia stays away or escalates strikes, and the US-Europe rift widens.
- **Signposts:** Kremlin confirmation, the Brussels outcome, whether Europe gets a seat, and ERAM missile contracting.

What to Watch

Date	Event	Why it matters
Wed 4 Nov (evening)	Brazil central bank (Copom) decision, per its published calendar (not re-verified)	First meeting since Lula's re-election; a pause in cuts is expected
Wed 4 Nov onward	South Africa local election results	ANC, DA and Zuma's MK party shares; coalition stability
Thu 5 Nov	Bank of England decision	Rate is 3.75%; some banks expect a 25 bp hike, and the September vote was 6-3 to hold
Fri 6 Nov	Deadline to nominate candidates for ECB president (per desk)	Starts the race to succeed Lagarde
Fri 6 Nov	US jobs report (usual first-Friday release, not verified)	Shapes Fed expectations after the midterms
Mon 9 Nov	Finance ministers (Ecofin/Eurogroup): Italy's escape clause and ECB candidates	The date is reported but I could not confirm it; check the Council calendar
About 10-11 Nov	Abu Dhabi talks (reported; Russian attendance unconfirmed)	First US contact with both sides since February
18-19 Nov	APEC leaders, Shenzhen (just outside the window)	Possible Trump-Xi meeting

Explained

The EU "national escape clause"

It is a safeguard clause in the EU's fiscal rules. Normally a country must keep its deficit under 3% of GDP and follow an agreed spending path. Under the clause, a government asks Brussels to exclude extra defence spending from that path. The Commission gives an opinion, then finance ministers vote. Think of it as a household allowed to buy a new roof without it counting against the monthly budget. Italy applied on 11 September, the Commission approved on 8 October, and the ministers' vote is expected around 9 November. The figure to remember is about 0.3% of GDP each for defence and energy in 2027 and 2028, within a 1.5% ceiling.

Real yield

A bond's headline yield is the interest it pays. The real yield subtracts inflation, so it shows what your money actually buys later. Take the 10-year BTP yield of 4.43% and subtract eurozone inflation of 4.0%. A saver earns about 0.4% a year before tax. It is like a bucket filling at 4.4 litres while 4.0 leak out. This matters because higher inflation erodes BTP income, even as the spread narrows. The number to remember is 0.4%.

Core versus headline inflation

Headline inflation counts all prices. Core strips out food and energy, which swing sharply, to reveal the underlying trend. The ECB watches both: energy can push headline up temporarily, but core and services show whether price rises are spreading. Today, headline is 4.0% but core is 2.5% and services 3.3%. The figure to remember is the ECB's 2% target.

Cloud rental as an export-control loophole

US rules limit sales of advanced AI chips to China. Chinese firms can rent computing power on foreign cloud servers instead. That is like being barred from buying a car but hiring one by the hour. The Oracle-Tencent deal, reportedly about 100,000 chips for around $7bn, was cancelled under US pressure. That signals rentals are now policed too. The figure to remember is $7bn.

Glossary

- **Basis point (bp):** one hundredth of a percentage point; 112 bp is 1.12 points.
- **BTP-Bund spread:** the yield gap between Italian and German 10-year bonds, a measure of Italian risk.
- **Eurostat flash estimate:** an early inflation figure that can be revised later.
- **ECB:** the European Central Bank, which sets eurozone interest rates.
- **Ecofin:** the EU finance ministers' council.
- **Strait of Hormuz:** the narrow Gulf waterway through which much of the world's oil and LNG passes.
- **TTF:** the Dutch gas price, Europe's gas benchmark.
- **Confindustria:** Italy's main employers' association.
- **Mimit:** Italy's Ministry of Enterprises and Made in Italy.
- **PNRR:** Italy's EU-funded recovery plan; the tenth, final instalment is €28.4bn.
- **ERAM:** Extended Range Attack Munition, a low-cost cruise missile being sought for Ukraine.
- **Apec:** the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation forum, meeting in Shenzhen on 18-19 November.

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